

Windows/Mac user account for each child. Net Nanny has a very user friendly web-based interface. Previous iterations used a Windows application, but Net Nanny ditched this so as to facilitate better integration with their smartphone app. This makes it possible to sync settings between your PC and smartphone, so any changes made on either platform are reflected across all devices.

The core feature of most parental control apps is the blocking of websites with inappropriate/harmful content. Net Nanny 7 allows you to customize the control settings for each account on the basis of pre-set configurations for different age groups such as child, pre-teen, teen, and adult: for example, you can allow your 14-year-old to visit news websites that may contain news articles with graphical and violent multimedia content, but you can restrict such content for your 8-year-old. You can choose to either block the website altogether or display a warning and give your child the choice to view the blocked website at their own discretion. Net Nanny 7 has a total of 17 different categories, and you can add your own URLs to categories for a more hands-on approach.

Net Nanny 7 can send parents a notification whenever their child attempts to access a website from a blocked category. For example, should your child attempt to visit a website seeking information on abortions or suicide, you will receive a notification via email, so you can act swiftly to counsel your child. The application also includes a special masking feature for websites in the “Profanity” category wherein the webpage will be allowed to load, but any offensive and profane terms will be appropriately censored using special characters.

Net Nanny lets parents set up an internet usage schedule for their kids. This way, they will only receive access to Internet access apps such as browsers, IM, and other web-based applications during a predetermined schedule, ensuring they don’t delay their bedtime or get distracted during homework. This scheduling can be taken a step further with the “Internet Allowance” feature, where you can give your kids a sort of “prepaid” account of Internet hours, which they can distribute evenly across their access time. Obviously, once a child uses up their hours, they will not be allowed to access the Internet until their account auto refills, which can be either daily or weekly. While some may see this as a step too far in terms of parental control, it can be a healthy remedy for children who are overly addicted to the Internet.

Net Nanny has an excellent and very customizable notification feature by which it emails you every time your kids attempt to access restricted